

Meta Platforms (META)

\$525.72 (Stock Price as of 03/27/2026)

Price Target (6-12 Months): **\$634.00**

Long Term: 6-12 Months | **Zacks Recommendation:** **Neutral**
(Since: 11/18/25)
Prior Recommendation: Outperform

Short Term: 1-3 Months | **Zacks Rank:** (1-5) **3-Hold**
Zacks Style Scores: VGM: A
Value: C | Growth: B | Momentum: A

Summary

Meta Platforms is benefiting from increasing AI-infusion across its services which currently reach more than 3.58 billion people daily. META's improved recommendation system is driving up user engagement. Instagram Reels had a strong fourth-quarter, with watch time up more than 30% year-over-year in the United States. Facebook video time continued to grow double-digits year-over-year in the United States. Recommendation improvement drove 20% lift in time spent on Threads. AI usage is making META a popular name among advertisers. Meta Platforms now expects to invest significantly more over the next few years in developing more advanced models and the largest AI services in the world. However, monetization of these AI services will take considerable time, which is a concern. Increasing regulatory challenges is a headwind for investors.

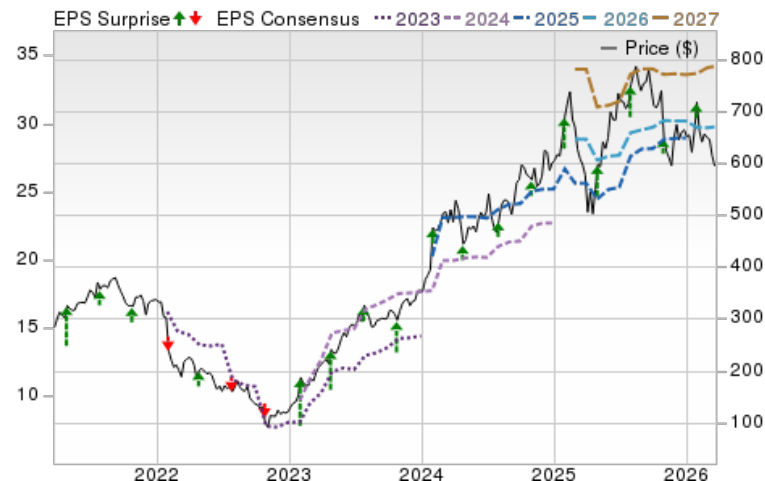
Data Overview

52 Week High-Low	\$796.25 - \$479.80
20 Day Average Volume (sh)	14,120,517
Market Cap	\$1,329.8 B
YTD Price Change	-20.4%
Beta	1.30
Dividend / Div Yld	\$2.10 / 0.4%
Industry	Internet - Software
Zacks Industry Rank	Bottom 38% (152 out of 244)

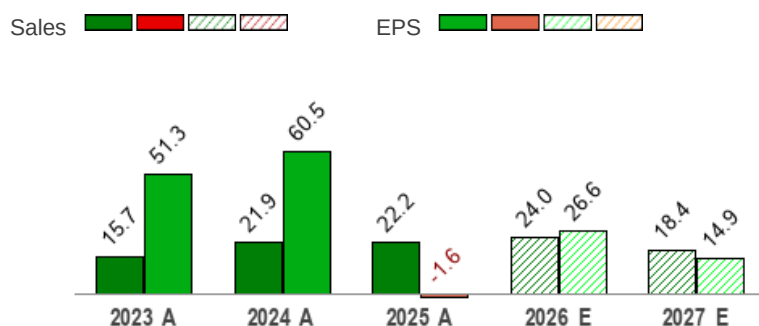
Last EPS Surprise	8.2%
Last Sales Surprise	2.2%
EPS F1 Est- 4 week change	-0.2%
Expected Report Date	04/29/2026
Earnings ESP	0.0%

P/E TTM	17.7
P/E F1	17.7
PEG F1	0.9
P/S TTM	6.6

Price, Consensus & Surprise⁽¹⁾



Sales and EPS Growth Rates (Y/Y %)⁽¹⁾



Sales Estimates (millions of \$)⁽¹⁾

	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Annual*
2027	64,554 E	70,063 E	73,977 E	85,396 E	295,178 E
2026	55,339 E	59,357 E	62,528 E	72,303 E	249,247 E
2025	42,314 A	47,516 A	51,242 A	59,893 A	200,966 A

EPS Estimates⁽¹⁾

	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Annual*
2027	7.55 E	8.20 E	8.30 E	9.89 E	34.18 E
2026	6.67 E	7.16 E	7.16 E	8.67 E	29.75 E
2025	6.43 A	7.14 A	7.25 A	8.88 A	23.49 A

*Quarterly figures may not add up to annual.

(1) The data in the charts and tables, including the Zacks Consensus EPS and sales estimates, is as of 03/27/2026.

(2) The report's text and the price target are as of 03/24/2026.

Overview

MetaPlatforms is the world's largest social media platform. The company's portfolio offering evolved from a single Facebook app to multiple apps like photo and video sharing app Instagram, and WhatsApp messaging app owing to acquisitions. Along with in-house developed Messenger, these apps now form Meta's family of products used by more than 3.58 billion people on a daily basis.

Headquartered in Menlo Park, CA, Meta generated revenues worth \$200.966 billion in 2025. Advertisement accounted for 97.6% of revenues. Marketers buy ads that can appear on multiple platforms including Facebook, Instagram, Messenger and third-party applications and websites.

Meta, thanks to its huge user base gained a significant market share in the advertising space wherein it faces tough competition from Alphabet's Google, Amazon and Snapchat-parent Snap.

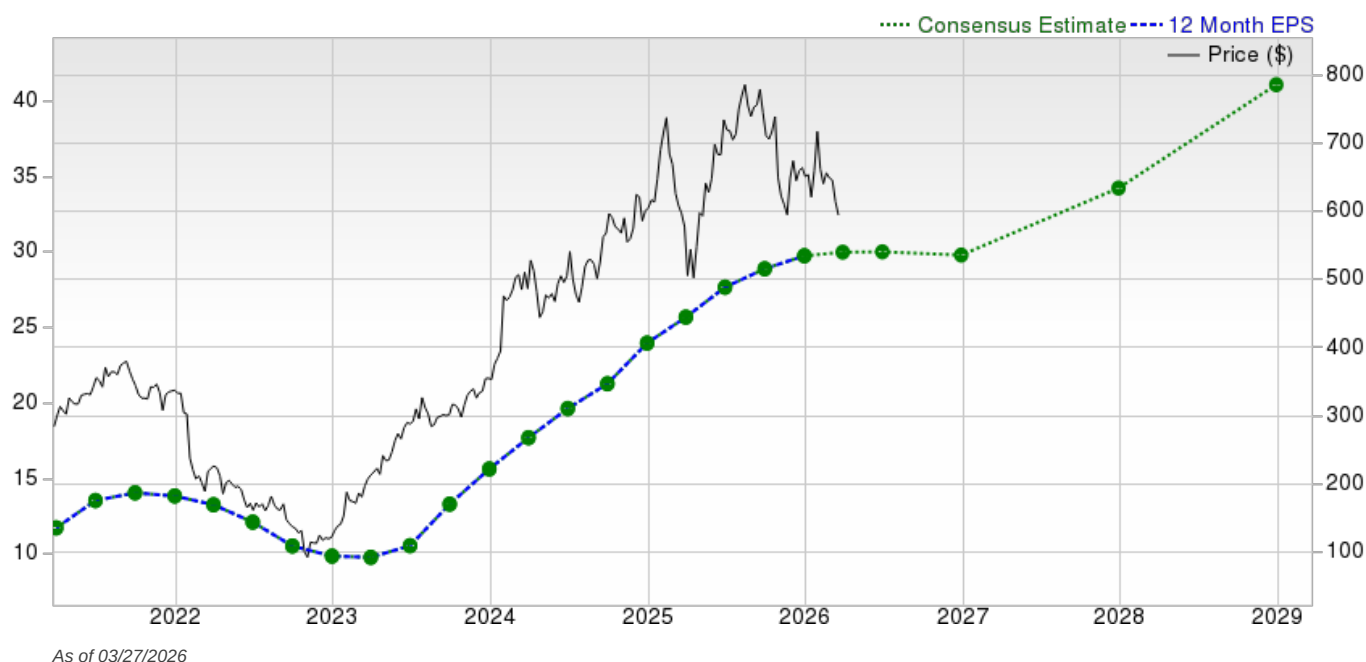
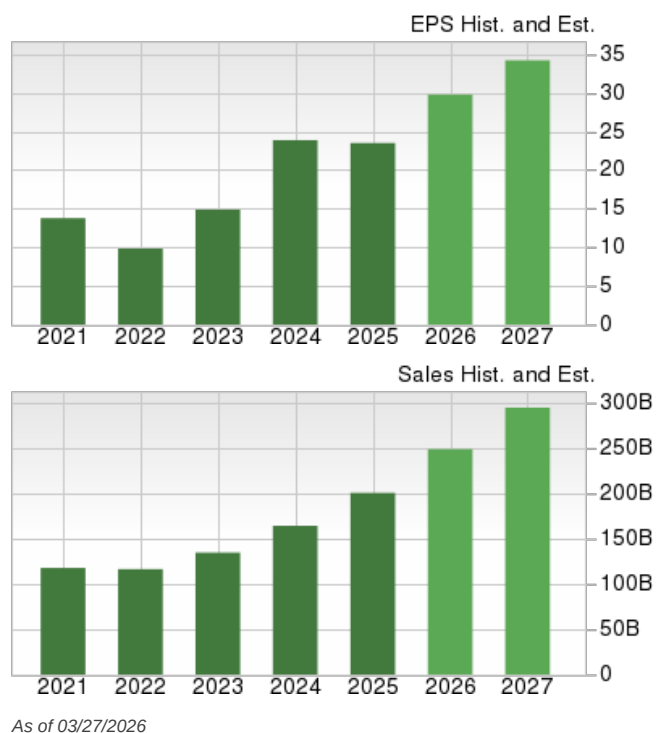
Meta also faces significant competition from the likes of Apple (messaging), YouTube (advertising and video), Bytedance (social media) and Tencent (messaging and social media).

Meta core app enables people to connect, share, discover and communicate with one other on mobile devices and personal computers. User engagement on core Meta platform is fostered by News Feed that displays an algorithmically-ranked series of stories and advertisements customized for each user.

Instagram is a community for sharing photos, videos and messages, enabling people to discover interests that they care about. People can express themselves through photos, videos and private messaging via Instagram Feed and Stories.

Messenger helps people to connect with friends, family, groups and businesses across platforms and devices. WhatsApp is a simple, reliable and secure messaging application, used by people and businesses around the world to communicate in a private way.

Meta also offers virtual reality (VR) products through its Oculus division.



Reasons To Buy:

- ▲ Meta Platforms' focus on integrating AI into its platforms — Facebook, WhatsApp, Instagram, Messenger and Threads — is driving user engagement to boost ad revenues. AI is heavily dependent on data, of which META has a trove, driven by its more than 3.54 billion daily users. Meta AI usage continues to increase, which is now available in more than 200 countries and territories. The company's initiative to add updates that will help Meta AI deliver more personalized and relevant responses is expected to boost engagement.
- ▲ Instagram has emerged as an important cash cow for Meta Platforms, supported by AI. Instagram Reels had a strong fourth-quarter, with watch time up more than 30% year-over-year in the United States. Improving the quality of recommendations is driving up engagement. Simplified ranking architecture has enabled more efficient model scaling that has unlocked the ability for Meta Platforms' systems to consider longer interaction histories to better identify a person's interests. On Instagram, the amount of original content in the United States increased 10% in the fourth quarter of 2025, with 75% of recommendations coming from original posts. META's new AI-powered recommendation model for ads is driving ad conversions on Instagram. Expanding social commerce is driving usage of Instagram as it remains popular among the younger demographic. Shopping tags and shop tab helps users discover products and purchase them over the Instagram platform, thereby driving monetization.
- ▲ WhatsApp is an extremely prized possession of Meta Platforms. Rapid adoption of WhatsApp Business by small and mid-sized businesses is noteworthy. META has introduced AI tools that help businesses on WhatsApp assist their customers and help them discover new products. Integrated AI helps businesses on WhatsApp create ads on Facebook and Instagram more easily. Meta Platforms is adding channel subscriptions, promoted channels and ads in Status in the WhatsApp updates tab, which is now used by more than 1.5 billion people globally. Moreover, Meta Verified on Instagram, Facebook and WhatsApp is a popular initiative under which the company offers four subscription plans to help businesses build credibility. All plans include the verified badge, account support and impersonation protection. This boosts consumer trust and attracts new businesses to the platforms.
- ▲ Meta Platforms' focus on developing strong footprint in metaverse will drive prospect over the long term. Oculus is the result of the company's ambitious mixed reality efforts which was built on a stack of AI technologies. Meta Platforms launched Oculus 2 in September 2020 and second-generation consumer virtual and mixed reality device in 2024. The company's AR glasses are leveraging an AI-centric operating system. The multi-year partnership with Rayban-parent EssilorLuxottica is noteworthy regarding the development of AR glasses, including the latest Oakley Meta glasses.
- ▲ Meta Platforms has a strong balance sheet and generates significant cash flow, which makes it an attractive stock for investors. As of Dec. 31, 2025, cash & cash equivalents and marketable securities were \$81.59 billion. We believe that Meta Platforms' ability to generate strong cash flows (free cash flow of \$14.08 billion in fourth-quarter 2025) will help it to make further investments in product development and acquisitions in the future. META continues to spend heavily on expanding AI infrastructure courtesy of the strong balance sheet. For 2026, capital expenditure is expected to be between \$115 billion and \$135 billion.

Meta Platforms benefits from infusion of AI into its platforms — Facebook, WhatsApp, Instagram, Messenger and Threads — that drives user engagement and ad revenues.

Reasons To Sell:

- ▼ Challenging macroeconomic conditions, including tariff uncertainties, do not bode well for Meta Platforms' advertising business. Higher tariffs are expected to hurt digital ad spending. We also believe sluggish monetization of new platforms, such as Threads and Meta AI, is a concern for investors. Meta Platforms plans to focus on scaling and deepening engagements for Meta AI over the next few years. Metaverse is yet to become a consistent revenue source. The Reality Labs segment is expected to continue reporting losses in 2026 at a rate similar to 2025.
- ▼ Meta Platforms currently faces stiff competition from other big and small social media players in terms of user acquisition. In the ad space, we believe that Alphabet continues to have a significant competitive edge, owing to its scale and diversified product offerings. YouTube, Snap and Pinterest offer tough competition as far as user growth is concerned. Amazon as well as Microsoft's ad business is growing rapidly. Intensifying competition for ad dollars is a major concern for Meta Platforms.
- ▼ Meta Platforms' focus on Reels, which generates lower revenues than Stories and News Feed, has been a headwind. The company continues to ramp up investments on products (Video, AR/VR and AI) as well as security; costs are already on the rise. Operating expenses are expected in the \$162-\$169 billion range for 2026, driven by higher infrastructure costs, which include third-party cloud spend, higher depreciation, and higher infrastructure operating expenses. Higher employee compensation driven by hires in AI space is expected to drive expenses. Although META expects 2026 operating income to be above 2025's reported figure, accelerating expenses will keep margins under pressure in the near term.
- ▼ As Meta Platforms hosts a huge amount of personal data, it has been under constant scrutiny from privacy groups and federal agencies. This huge database is its primary asset for attracting advertisers. As a result, the company has been criticized for allegedly selling personal data to advertisers in order to boost its top line. Meta Platforms also finds itself increasingly at loggerheads with authorities across different countries who accuse the social media giant of repeatedly failing to co-operate with them on extremely sensitive matters. META is facing regulations under the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), Digital Markets Act (DMA), Digital Services Act (DSA), Artificial Intelligence Act (EU AI Act), and the UK Digital Markets, Competition and Consumer Act (DMCC), making the stock risky for investors.

Stiff competition for ad dollars, a plethora of controversies over the company's treatment of user data and increasing regulations related to user privacy are key concerns.

Last Earnings Report

META Q4 Earnings & Revenues Beat Estimates

Meta Platforms reported fourth-quarter 2025 non-GAAP earnings of \$8.88 per share, beating the Zacks Consensus Estimate by 8.16%.

Revenues of \$59.89 billion beat the Zacks Consensus Estimate by 2.22% and increased 23.8% year over year. At constant currency (cc), revenues soared 23% year over year.

FY Quarter Ending **12/31/2025**

Earnings Reporting Date	Jan 28, 2026
Sales Surprise	2.22%
EPS Surprise	8.16%
Quarterly EPS	8.88
Annual EPS (TTM)	29.70

META's Top-Line Growth Rides on Strong User Base

Revenues from Family of Apps (98.4% of total revenues), which includes Facebook, Instagram, Messenger, WhatsApp and other services, increased 24.6% year over year to \$58.94 billion. The top-line growth benefited from WhatsApp paid messaging revenue growth as well as Meta Verified subscriptions.

Family Daily Active People or DAP, defined as a registered and logged-in user who visited at least one of the Family products (Facebook, Instagram, Messenger and/or WhatsApp) on a given day, was 3.58 billion, up 7% year over year. Geographically, revenues from the United States & Canada, Asia-Pacific, Europe and the Rest of the World (RoW) surged 21.5%, 21%, 25.9% and 32.5% on a year-over-year basis, respectively.

Instagram Reels had a strong quarter, with watch time up more than 30% year-over-year in the United States. Improving the quality of recommendations is driving up engagement. Simplified ranking architecture has enabled more efficient model scaling that has unlocked the ability for Meta Platforms' systems to consider longer interaction histories to better identify a person's interests. On Instagram, the amount of original content in the United States increased 10% in the fourth quarter of 2025, with 75% of recommendations coming from original posts.

Facebook video time continued to grow double-digits year-over-year in the United States. The company saw strong results from ranking and product improvement efforts on both Feed and video surfaces. The optimizations META made in the reported quarter drove a 7% lift in views of organic Feed and video posts on Facebook. Recommendation improvement drove 20% lift in time spent on Threads.

META's Advertising Revenues Jump Y/Y

Advertising revenues (98.6% of Family of Apps revenues) increased 24.3% year over year to \$58.14 billion and accounted for 97.1% of fourth-quarter revenues. At cc, revenues increased 23% year over year.

Advertising revenues from the United States & Canada, Asia-Pacific, Europe and the RoW surged 22.2%, 20.9%, 27.3% and 37.6% on a year-over-year basis, respectively.

Ad impressions delivered across Family of Apps increased 18% year over year, and the average price per ad jumped 6% in the reported quarter. Impression growth from Asia-Pacific, the RoW, the United States & Canada and Europe was 24%, 14%, 13% and 13%, respectively. Impression growth was driven primarily by engagement and user growth, and to a lesser degree, ad load optimizations.

Family of Apps' other revenues soared 54.3% year over year to \$801 million. Reality Labs' revenues (1.6% of total revenues) dropped 11.8% year over year to \$955 million.

Higher Costs Hurt META's Q4 Operating Margin

In the fourth quarter of 2025, total costs and expenses increased 40.5% year over year to \$35.15 billion. As a percentage of revenues, total costs and expenses were 58.7%, up 700 basis points (bps) year over year.

As a percentage of revenues, marketing & sales expenses decreased 100 bps, while general & administrative expenses increased 460 bps on a year-over-year basis. Research & development expenses, as a percentage of revenues, were 28.6%, up 340 bps on a year-over-year basis.

Meta Platforms' employee base was 78,865 at the end of the fourth quarter, up 6% year over year.

Operating income of \$24.75 billion climbed 18.4% year over year. The operating margin was 41.3%, which contracted 700 bps year over year. Family of Apps' operating income increased 51.4% year over year to \$30.77 billion. Reality Labs reported a loss of \$6.02 billion compared with a loss of \$4.97 billion.

META's Balance Sheet & Cash Flow Remains Strong

As of Dec. 31, 2025, cash & cash equivalents and marketable securities were \$81.59 billion compared with \$44.45 billion as of Sept. 30, 2025.

Long-term debt was \$58.74 billion as of Dec. 31, 2025, unchanged from the figure reported as of Sept. 30, 2025.

Capital expenditures were \$22.14 billion in the fourth quarter, while free cash flow was \$14.08 billion.

META Offers Positive Guidance

Meta Platforms expects total revenues between \$53.5 billion and \$56.5 billion for the first quarter of 2026, including 4% tailwind from favorable forex.

For 2026, META anticipates total expenses between \$162 billion and \$169 billion, driven by higher infrastructure costs, which include third-party cloud spend, higher depreciation, and higher infrastructure operating expenses. Higher employee compensation driven by hires in AI space is expected to drive expenses.

Operating income for 2026 is expected to be above 2025's reported figure.

META expects 2026 capital expenditure to be in the range of \$115-\$135, driven by increased investment to support Meta Superintelligence Labs efforts and core business.

Recent News

2026

On Feb. 26, Meta Platforms announced that in upcoming weeks Instagram will start notifying parents using supervision if their teen repeatedly tries to search for terms related to suicide or self-harm.

On Feb. 24, Meta Platforms announced a multi-year agreement with AMD to power its AI infrastructure with up to 6GW of its Instinct GPUs.

On Feb. 17, META announced a multi-year strategic partnership with NVIDIA to advance its long-term AI infrastructure roadmap.

On Jan. 27, Meta Platforms announced a multi-year agreement with Corning worth \$6 billion under which the latter will supply fiber optic cables for META's data centers.

On Jan. 9, Meta Platforms announced that it has signed long-term nuclear power agreements with Vistra, TerraPower and Oklo that are designed to supply up to 6.6 gigawatts (GWs) of nuclear electricity by 2035.

2025

On Dec. 5, Meta Platforms announced that Meta AI will offer broader range of real-time content, including global news, entertainment, lifestyle stories, and more across its apps and devices. META's partnerships with publications including CNN, Fox News, Le Monde Group, People Inc., and USA TODAY will help the company offer this expanded service.

On Dec. 4, Meta Platforms announced new and easier ways to get account support and sharing updates for users' Facebook and Instagram accounts through advancements in AI. The company is launching a new, centralized hub on Facebook and Instagram that brings support tools and options into one place. Users can now report an account issue, find quick answers with the help of Meta AI-powered search, and more. META is also testing an AI support assistant for instant, personalized help for users need to recover their account, update settings or manage their profile.

Valuation

Meta Platforms shares have declined 19.4% in the past six-month period and 3.5% over the trailing 12-month period. Stocks in the Zacks sub-industry have dropped 24.4% in the past six-month period while the Zacks Computer & Technology sector declined 1.6%. Over the past year, the Zacks sub-industry declined 11.2% while the sector appreciated 26.9%.

The S&P 500 Index is up 0.6% in the past six-month period and 16.9% in the past year.

The stock is currently trading at 19.64X forward 12-month earnings, which compares to 26.3X for the Zacks sub-industry, 23.1X for the Zacks sector and 20.83X for the S&P 500 index.

Over the past five years, the stock has traded as high as 28.42X and as low as 9.47X, with a 5-year median of 21.85X. Our Neutral recommendation indicates that the stock will perform in line with the market. Our \$634 price target reflects 20.62X forward 12-month earnings.

The table below shows summary valuation data for META

Valuation Multiples - META					
		Stock	Sub-Industry	Sector	S&P 500
P/E F12M	Current	19.64	26.3	23.1	20.83
	5-Year High	28.42	67.92	29.9	23.8
	5-Year Low	9.47	26.3	18.67	15.73
	5-Year Median	21.85	39.1	26.11	21.19
P/B TTM	Current	7.03	4.52	9.16	7.64
	5-Year High	10.22	6.93	11.79	9.15
	5-Year Low	1.9	2.79	6.65	6.59
	5-Year Median	7.05	5.19	9.79	8.09
EV/Sales TTM	Current	7.49	4.55	7.16	5.28
	5-Year High	11.05	7.2	8.44	5.83
	5-Year Low	1.73	2.69	4.24	3.76
	5-Year Median	7.93	5.15	7	5.12

As of 03/23/2026

Source: Zacks Investment Research

Industry Analysis⁽¹⁾ Zacks Industry Rank: Bottom 38% (152 out of 244)



Top Peers⁽¹⁾

Company (Ticker)	Rec	Rank
Bumble Inc. (BMBL)	Neutral	3
Alphabet Inc. (GOOGL)	Neutral	3
Microsoft Corporation...(MSFT)	Neutral	3
Match Group Inc. (MTCH)	Neutral	3
Netflix, Inc. (NFLX)	Neutral	3
Pinterest, Inc. (PINS)	Neutral	4
Snap Inc. (SNAP)	Neutral	3
Weibo Corporation (WB)	Neutral	2

Industry Comparison⁽¹⁾ Industry: Internet - Software

	META	X Industry	S&P 500	BMBL	GOOGL	PINS
Zacks Recommendation (Long Term)	Neutral	-	-	Neutral	Neutral	Neutral
Zacks Rank (Short Term)	3	-	-	3	3	4
VGM Score	A	-	-	A	B	B
Market Cap	1,329.84 B	642.23 M	38.90 B	418.01 M	3,318.69 B	11.81 B
# of Analysts	20	3	22	5	19	10
Dividend Yield	0.40%	0.00%	1.52%	0.00%	0.31%	0.00%
Value Score	C	-	-	A	D	C
Cash/Price	0.05	0.17	0.04	0.38	0.03	0.20
EV/EBITDA	12.50	7.28	13.42	-1.04	17.99	20.63
PEG Ratio	0.86	1.02	1.76	0.11	1.61	0.41
Price/Book (P/B)	6.12	2.60	3.29	0.61	7.99	2.49
Price/Cash Flow (P/CF)	14.00	17.18	13.72	1.15	21.65	59.95
P/E (F1)	17.67	18.36	17.87	3.30	23.64	10.13
Price/Sales (P/S)	6.62	2.75	3.01	0.43	8.24	2.80
Earnings Yield	5.66%	4.68%	5.59%	30.43%	4.23%	9.85%
Debt/Equity	0.27	0.00	0.56	0.86	0.11	0.00
Cash Flow (\$/share)	37.56	0.22	9.62	2.80	12.67	0.30
Growth Score	A	-	-	D	B	A
Hist. EPS Growth (3-5 yrs)	23.21%	15.26%	7.51%	NA	19.99%	12.82%
Proj. EPS Growth (F1/F0)	26.65%	24.58%	9.87%	NA	7.40%	9.38%
Curr. Cash Flow Growth	22.02%	-1.09%	7.92%	-174.53%	32.81%	-31.69%
Hist. Cash Flow Growth (3-5 yrs)	21.41%	17.51%	8.87%	56.10%	23.22%	199.63%
Current Ratio	2.60	1.60	1.19	2.21	2.01	7.64
Debt/Capital	21.28%	2.06%	38.05%	46.11%	10.08%	0.00%
Net Margin	30.08%	-0.16%	12.73%	-72.74%	32.81%	9.87%
Return on Equity	38.61%	2.89%	17.16%	24.58%	35.01%	7.95%
Sales/Assets	0.65	0.59	0.53	0.47	0.76	0.78
Proj. Sales Growth (F1/F0)	24.00%	10.47%	5.59%	-11.70%	18.70%	13.10%
Momentum Score	A	-	-	A	A	C
Daily Price Chg	-3.99%	-3.12%	-1.67%	-3.30%	-2.34%	-1.11%
1 Week Price Chg	-3.27%	-1.40%	-3.60%	-5.31%	-0.42%	2.75%
4 Week Price Chg	-19.98%	-8.74%	-7.82%	3.54%	-10.75%	-0.28%
12 Week Price Chg	-20.36%	-24.05%	-6.96%	-9.80%	-12.35%	-31.40%
52 Week Price Chg	-12.76%	-28.72%	11.87%	-28.76%	69.10%	-44.91%
20 Day Average Volume	14,120,517	903,965	3,196,808	6,626,687	30,037,466	21,430,840
(F1) EPS Est 1 week change	0.01%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.02%	0.00%
(F1) EPS Est 4 week change	-0.19%	0.00%	0.00%	11.01%	0.02%	0.72%
(F1) EPS Est 12 week change	-1.41%	0.01%	0.47%	7.70%	5.11%	-21.18%
(Q1) EPS Est Mthly Chg	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	73.95%	0.00%	-33.20%

Zacks Stock Rating System

We offer two rating systems that take into account investors' holding horizons: Zacks Rank and Zacks Recommendation. Each provides valuable insights into the future profitability of the stock and can be used separately or in combination with each other depending on your investment style.

Zacks Recommendation

The Zacks Recommendation aims to predict performance over the next 6 to 12 months. The foundation for the quantitatively determined Zacks Recommendation is trends in the company's estimate revisions and earnings outlook. The Zacks Recommendation is broken down into 3 Levels; Outperform, Neutral and Underperform. Unlike many Wall Street firms, we have an excellent balance between the number of Outperform and Neutral recommendations. Our team of 70 analysts are fully versed in the benefits of earnings estimate revisions and how that is harnessed through the Zacks quantitative rating system. But we have given our analysts the ability to override the Zacks Recommendation for the 1200 stocks that they follow. The reason for the analyst over-rides is that there are often factors such as valuation, industry conditions and management effectiveness that a trained investment professional can spot better than a quantitative model.

Zacks Rank

The Zacks Rank is our short-term rating system that is most effective over the one- to three-month holding horizon. The underlying driver for the quantitatively-determined Zacks Rank is the same as the Zacks Recommendation, and reflects trends in earnings estimate revisions.

Zacks Style Scores

The Zacks Style Score is as a complementary indicator to the Zacks rating system, giving investors a way to focus on the highest rated stocks that best fit their own stock picking preferences.

Academic research has proven that stocks with the best Value, Growth and Momentum characteristics outperform the market. The Zacks Style Scores rate stocks on each of these individual styles and assigns a rating of A, B, C, D and F. We also produce the VGM Score (V for Value, G for Growth and M for Momentum), which combines the weighted average of the individual Style Scores into one score. This is perfectly suited for those who want their stocks to have the best scores across the board.

Value Score	C
Growth Score	B
Momentum Score	A
VGM Score	A

As an investor, you want to buy stocks with the highest probability of success. That means buying stocks with a Zacks Recommendation of Outperform, which also has a Style Score of an A or a B.

Disclosures

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